

6. Likelihood and lexical coverage are separate diagnostics

OUTPUT *Abstract.* The mirror-cost study reports two different signals. Causal-LM cost measures the relative probability assigned to matched segmentations; dictionary-word coverage measures the fraction of letters placed in words of three or more letters, preventing one-letter tiling from looking like successful lexicalization. Across the retained conditions, forward coverage is about 88–92% and reverse coverage about 48–55%. The two diagnostics agree that reversal disrupts ordinary lexical structure.

CRITIQUE Dictionary coverage can still be misleading: a fully segmentable word sequence can be ungrammatical or absurd. Conversely, a reverse stream with low coverage is not automatically unreadable. Treating coverage as fluency would reinstate the overclaim removed in the previous pass.

REVISION APPLIED Label coverage as a model-free companion diagnostic only, and explicitly rule out readability, grammaticality, and semantic conclusions from it.